

Ohio River Trail Council Cycling Club

Sandy Creek Trail

24.6-Mile Bike Ride

City/State: Franklin, Pa

County: Venango

Date: Saturday, May 19, 2012

Time: 1:00 pm

Meeting Point: [Fisherman's Cove Trailhead](#) (Google Map)

Surface: Paved asphalt

RSVP: ortctrailride@gmail.com



Come out for a ride! This is part of a trail ride series sponsored by the Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC) intended to bring awareness to the wonderful trails in our 4-state region (Maryland, Ohio, Pennsylvania and West Virginia).

All riders are welcome for this rails-to-trails, moderate-paced ride!

For this ride...

The ORTC Cycling Club visits the Sandy Creek Trail which carves its way through some of the most remote and spectacular countryside in northwestern Pennsylvania. This 12.3-mile paved trail has some impressive features, including tunnels and massive trestles like the Belmar Bridge, which crosses the mighty Allegheny River. The Sandy Creek Trail is a rails-to-trails conversion of the former Franklin and Clearfield RR, built in 1905-1911 for freight and passenger use. The line was phased out in the 1980s. The East Sandy Creek is a Pennsylvania Scenic River.

[Sandy Creek Trail Map](#)

Features of Interest:

The spectacular 1,385-foot Belmar Bridge over the Allegheny River is a stunning example of the once booming railroad industry in the area. Built in 1907 with funding from local oil man Charles Miller and John D. Rockefeller, the bridge was intended to serve as a vital link on a corridor from New York to Chicago. In the end, the trestle and corridor were used more regularly to service the local coal industry which transported much of the coal from Clarion County to Ashtabula on Lake Erie.

Don't forget your camera!

Carpooling:

We are glad to facilitate carpooling as well. Just RSVP or contact Nathan Peluso at ortctrailride@gmail.com. Carpooling meeting locations are Beaver, Cranberry Twp., Moon Twp., or Pittsburgh, Pa.

**Weather & Cancellations:**

The weather forecast is mostly sunny and 80 degrees. Please visit the [ORTC website](#) for cancellations before you depart for the trail. In addition, persons who RSVP will be sent an email regarding schedule changes. Rides that are cancelled due to inclement weather are usually rescheduled for the next day for Saturday rides or the following week for Sunday rides.

Trailhead Address and Directions:

Old Rt. 8 and Damascus Rd. at Fisherman's Cove, Victory, Pa. Turn right at the foot of the hill, and travel along the dirt road about 4 miles. At a sharp right turn, the trail is just ahead. Park along the road.

[Fisherman's Cove directional sign](#)

To reach the Fisherman's Cove Trailhead at the far western end of the trail by traveling on old Route 8 (north from I-80 turn to old Route 8 just north of Barkeyville, or south by leaving new Route 8 just south of Franklin before new Route 8 becomes a divided highway) and turning off onto a dirt road at the end of the Pecan Bridge at the sign that leads to Seneca Hills Bible Camp. Turn right at the foot of the hill, and travel along the dirt road about 4 miles. At a sharp right turn, the trail is just ahead. Park along the road.

[Fisherman's Cove Trailhead Map](#)[Fisherman's Cove Trailhead Photo #1](#)

Drive time from Pittsburgh: 90 minutes

Drive time from Monaca: 86 minutes

GPS: LAT:41.335238, LONG:-79.887407

Website Links:

<http://www.avta-trails.org/sandy-creek-trail.html>

<http://www.traillink.com/trail/sandy-creek-trail.aspx>

Lunch:

We will meet for lunch after the ride.

Ohio River Trail Council

The Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC) is currently planning & developing a 41-mile bike and water trail, the Ohio River Trail (ORT), along the Ohio River, from Coraopolis, Pa (near Pittsburgh) to Ohioville, Pa. (near East Liverpool, OH). The ORT is part of the *Rivers of Steel National Heritage Area*, *Lewis & Clark Trail* and is a candidate for part of the *U.S. Bicycle Route 50, Pittsburgh to Cleveland Trail*, and a portion of the *Underground Railroad Bicycle Route, Pittsburgh spur*. The proposed ORT will also follow parts of the "Great Path" and the *Lincoln Highway*. The ORT will serve as a key segment in the interconnection of existing land trails in the quad-state area (Maryland, Ohio, Pennsylvania and West Virginia). Specifically, the proposed Ohio River Trail will connect the *Great Ohio Lake-to-River Greenway* in Columbiana County, Ohio to the *Great Allegheny Passage* in Allegheny, County Pennsylvania forming a mega-trail from the great lakes region to our nation's capitol.



Donations

The ORTC is an organization committed to excellence, with a clear vision and a passion for delivering outstanding results. We ask you to form an alliance with us to capitalize on our strengths in order to guarantee a bright future for our rivers, forests, and towns. Please visit www.ohiorivertrail.org for additional information and a [donation form](#).



Ohio River Trail Cycling Club

The Ohio River Trail Cycling Club is a recreational club that promotes health, wellness and fitness in our community through a variety of biking events. Our goal is to encourage cyclists of all abilities to explore the wonderful opportunities of the region - from the Heritage Trail of Pittsburgh to the rural scenery of the 4-state area, including Maryland, Ohio, Pennsylvania and West Virginia. The club provides cyclists with a diversity of riding experiences. Ohio River Trail Council members can be seen on city bikes, comfort bikes, cyclocross bikes, hybrids, mountain bikes, recumbents, road bikes, touring bikes and tandems.

The ORTC Cycling Club supports and promotes safe bicycle riding. If you have been inactive for several years or are currently under medical care, please consult your doctor before starting a new exercise program. It is highly recommended to always carry water and food. In addition, please bring a spare tube, pump and tools to replace a flat tire. A Consumer Product Safety Commission (CPSC) approved bicycle helmet securely fitted and fastened is required on all ORTC Trail Series Rides. In order to participate in our events please print and sign the [OHIO RIVER TRAIL COUNCIL CYCLING CLUB RELEASE](#) and mail to ORTC 1100 Pennsylvania Av Monaca, Pa 15061. The ORTC club members serve as ambassadors for bicycling every time we ride thus projecting a positive image of bicycling to the public. Always follow the rules of the road!

About the Trail Ride Series:

- Trails rides are 10-50 miles in length.
- Moderate and self-paced rides located within a 2 hour drive of Pittsburgh, Pa.
- Meet for lunch or dinner either mid-way or at the end.
- Two - four rides per month on Saturday or Sunday.
- Feel free to forward this email. This publication is intended for widespread distribution.

Example rides include the [Allegheny Highlands Trail](#), [Allegheny River & Samuel Justus Trails](#), [Armstrong Trail](#), [Arrowhead Trail](#), [Bike and Hike Trail](#), [Butler-Freeport Trail](#), [C & O Canal Towpath Trail](#), [Conotton Creek Trail](#), [Deckers Creek Trail](#), [Ghost Town Trail](#), [Greater Wheeling Trail](#), [Hoodlebug Trail](#), [Little Beaver Creek Greenway](#), [Lower Trail](#), [Mahoning Shadow Trail](#), [Maurice K. Goddard State Park Trail](#), [Mill Creek MetroParks Bikeway](#), [Montour Trail](#), [Ohio & Erie Canal Towpath Trail](#), [Oil Creek State Park Trail](#), [Panhandle Trail](#), [Pine Creek Trail](#), [Sandy Creek Trail](#), [Stavich Trail](#), [Steel Valley Trail](#), [Three Rivers Heritage Trail](#), [Western Reserve Greenway Trumbull MetroParks](#), [West Penn Trail](#), and [Youghiogheny River Trail](#).

Ride Schedule

Please refer to the provisional ORTC Trail Series [Ride Schedule](#) or ORTC [Event Calendar](#) for additional dates and times. Click here to view the [ORTC meeting schedule](#).

Membership

To join the Ohio River Trail Council and become a member of the ORTC Cycling Club please download a [membership application](#) and mail your contribution to the ORTC office. Feel free to forward this message to a friend.



Correspondence

Please visit our [website](#) and [register](#) to receive ORTC correspondence. Thank you for your support.



For questions and comments please contact:

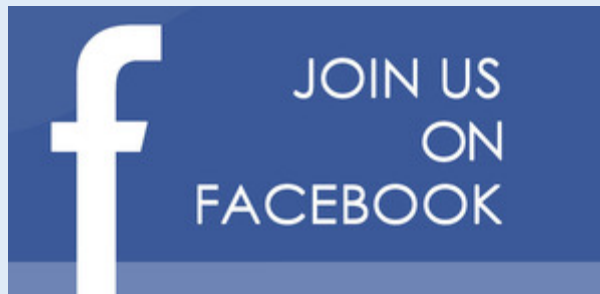
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